Laurel Oak, Darlington Oak, Sand Laurel Oak

Quercus hemisphaerica

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Rockery: 1 **TOTAL 1**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 40–60 ft (up to 70+ ft). Confirmed by multiple nursery and botanical sources (40–60 ft typical). × 30–45 ft. Confirmed.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 6–9. Native to southeastern U.S. including Georgia. Semi-evergreen to tardily deciduous in Atlanta. Performs well as a fast-growing shade tree on well-drained soils. Often used as street or parking lot tree in the South. Glossy green leaves persist into winter. Adaptable once established.
Sun: Full sun to part shade.
Water: Low to medium. Drought tolerant once established. Prefers well-drained; tolerates some moisture.
Soil: Sandy, loam, clay. Acidic preferred. Well-drained. Adaptable to urban soils.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun in well-drained soil. Water until established. Fast-growing shade or street tree. Suitable for parking lots and urban sites where space allows. Glossy foliage provides year-round interest in mild winters.
Soil prep: Sandy, loam, clay. Acidic preferred. Well-drained. Adaptable to urban soils.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Moderately dry sandy soils, scrub sandhills, stream banks, hillsides. Coastal plain and Piedmont.
Form / habit: Deciduous to semi-evergreen. Medium to large tree. Rounded to oval dense crown. Fast growth.
Foliage: Leaves often persist green into winter; little true fall color (tardily deciduous).
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Similar to related laurel oaks; gray-brown, furrowed with age.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally few serious pests. Possible oak issues. No serious problems stated in primary sources. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Narrow elliptic leaves, mostly entire. - Closely related to and often confused with Q. laurifolia. - Fast growth, dense canopy. - Popular southern landscape and street tree. - Acorns for wildlife.

Sources: - Flora of North America - Gardenia.net / nursery summaries - UF/IFAS related (Q. laurifolia notes) - Multiple botanical references